

The 6-Area Team Check

A 10-minute look at work-related stress risks, built on HSE's Management Standards

How to use it. Answer for your team as it is today, not as it should be. Tick one box per line: **Usually = 2, Sometimes = 1, Rarely = 0.** Add the two lines for each area (0–4). Better still, ask your team to fill it in anonymously and compare.

AREA	STATEMENT	USUALLY	SOMETIMES	RARELY	AREA TOTAL
Demands	Workloads are achievable in the hours people actually work.	☐	☐	☐	
	People can take their breaks and leave on time most days.	☐	☐	☐	
Control	People have a say in how they do their work.	☐	☐	☐	
	People can set their own pace when it matters.	☐	☐	☐	
Support	Managers notice and respond when someone is struggling.	☐	☐	☐	
	People know where to get help, at work and outside it.	☐	☐	☐	
Relationships	Unacceptable behaviour, including bullying and harassment, is dealt with quickly.	☐	☐	☐	
	People feel able to raise a concern without fear.	☐	☐	☐	
Role	Everyone knows what is expected of them.	☐	☐	☐	
	People are rarely given conflicting demands.	☐	☐	☐	
Change	Changes are explained before they happen.	☐	☐	☐	
	People are consulted on changes that affect them.	☐	☐	☐	

Reading your scores

- **0–1:** act here first. Talk to the team and agree one change.
- **2–3:** keep an eye on it; ask what would help.
- **4:** a strength. Note what makes it work.

Why it matters

- Employers must assess the risk of work-related stress, like any other risk.
- With five or more employees, the significant findings must be written down.
- From 30 October 2026, employers must take all reasonable steps to prevent sexual harassment.

Next step

This check shows *where* to look. **The Manager's Pack** helps you run one team conversation, agree actions and keep a written record, using an editable action plan. sanaessencia.co.uk